

Ava Iranmanesh

University Park, State College, PA, USA

+1 8145040606

ami5520@psu.edu

ava-iranmanesh.github.io

in ava-iranmanesh

Education

2024–27 **B.Sc. in Computer Science**, Penn State University (Schreyer Honors College), PA, USA

Summer 2024 **Summer Exchange student**, HKUST, Hong Kong SAR

Research Interests

Machine Learning

AI Safety

NLP

Pluralistic Alignment

Human-AI Interaction

Evaluation

Publications

HearSay: Can LLMs Navigate from Abstract Human Rights to Lived Lives?

NeurIPS 2026 Evaluations & Datasets Track · Oral Presentation (top 0.4%)

Ava Iranmanesh, Sobhan Lotfi, Ali Iranmanesh, Liwei Jiang

Position: There are futures that benchmark-driven AI cannot see

ICML 2026 · Oral Presentation (top 0.7%)

Ava Iranmanesh, Sobhan Lotfi, Lachin Naghashyar, Ali Shirali, Fateme Nateghi Haredasht, Sanmi Koyejo, Philip Torr, Yong Suk Lee, Fazl Barez, Joel Lehman, Peter Norvig, Arvind Narayanan

Smolder: Empathy, Collapse, and What Remains for AI Risk

CSCW Positech 2026

Ava Iranmanesh, Daryl Cameron

Honors and Awards

Dec. 2026 **Oral Presentation** selection at **NeurIPS 2026**

One of 15 orals selected from 3,757 submissions (top 0.4%).

May 2026 **Oral Presentation** selection at **ICML 2026**

One of 168 orals selected from 24,371 submissions (top 0.7%).

Jun 2026 **Selected for Penn State's MCREU Fellowship**, State College

One of 75 fellows selected from 9,000+ applicants (top 0.8%).

Dec 2025 **Selected for NTU Global Connect Fellowship**, Singapore

One of 12 fellows selected from 2,700+ applicants (top 0.5%).

Research Experience

2026 Winter **University of Washington**, remote

Supervisor: Dr. Liwei Jiang

- Built HearSay, a benchmark asking whether LLMs can move from abstract human rights to advice that fits a person's actual life, framed with Sen's capability approach and Gricean pragmatics.
- Designed the prompts and a five-axis failure taxonomy, and built the human-verification platform.

Fall 2025 **Penn State University**

Supervisor: Prof. Daryl Cameron

- Working on a paper on the relation of empathy and compassion with AI existential risks accepted to CSCW Positech workshop 2026.

Skills

Programming Python, C/C++, R

ML & Science PyTorch, Scikit-learn, NumPy

Infrastructure Git, LaTeX, Linux

Languages English (Fluent), Persian (Native), German (B2)

Service

TA Data Structures and Algorithms

Resident Penn State University

Assistant